

August

23



1898

Southern Cross Expedition

Led by Anglo-Norwegian explorer Carsten Borchgrevink, the first British expedition to Antarctica set sail on a ship called *Southern Cross*. Its crew was the first to spend winter on the Antarctic mainland.

Also on this day

1942 The Battle of Stalingrad began as Soviet forces fought the Nazis for control of the Russian city of Stalingrad.

1966 The first photograph of Earth taken from orbit around the Moon was captured by NASA's robotic spacecraft *Lunar Orbiter 1*.

1991 The World Wide Web was opened to the public by its inventor, Tim Berners-Lee.

1989 Baltic chain

About 2 million people sang and held hands to form a human chain stretching more than 600 km (373 miles) through the countries of Estonia, Latvia, and Lithuania. The protest demonstrated their shared goal of independence from Soviet rule.

Born this day

1769 Georges Cuvier, French naturalist. He made important contributions to the study of fossils and proved that it was possible for species to become extinct.

1988 Jeremy Lin, US basketball player. He is the first Asian American to win a National Basketball Association (NBA) championship.

Hashtag tweet

2007

The hashtag (#) symbol was first used in a tweet when US blogger Chris Messina posted “#barcamp” on the social media site Twitter.

